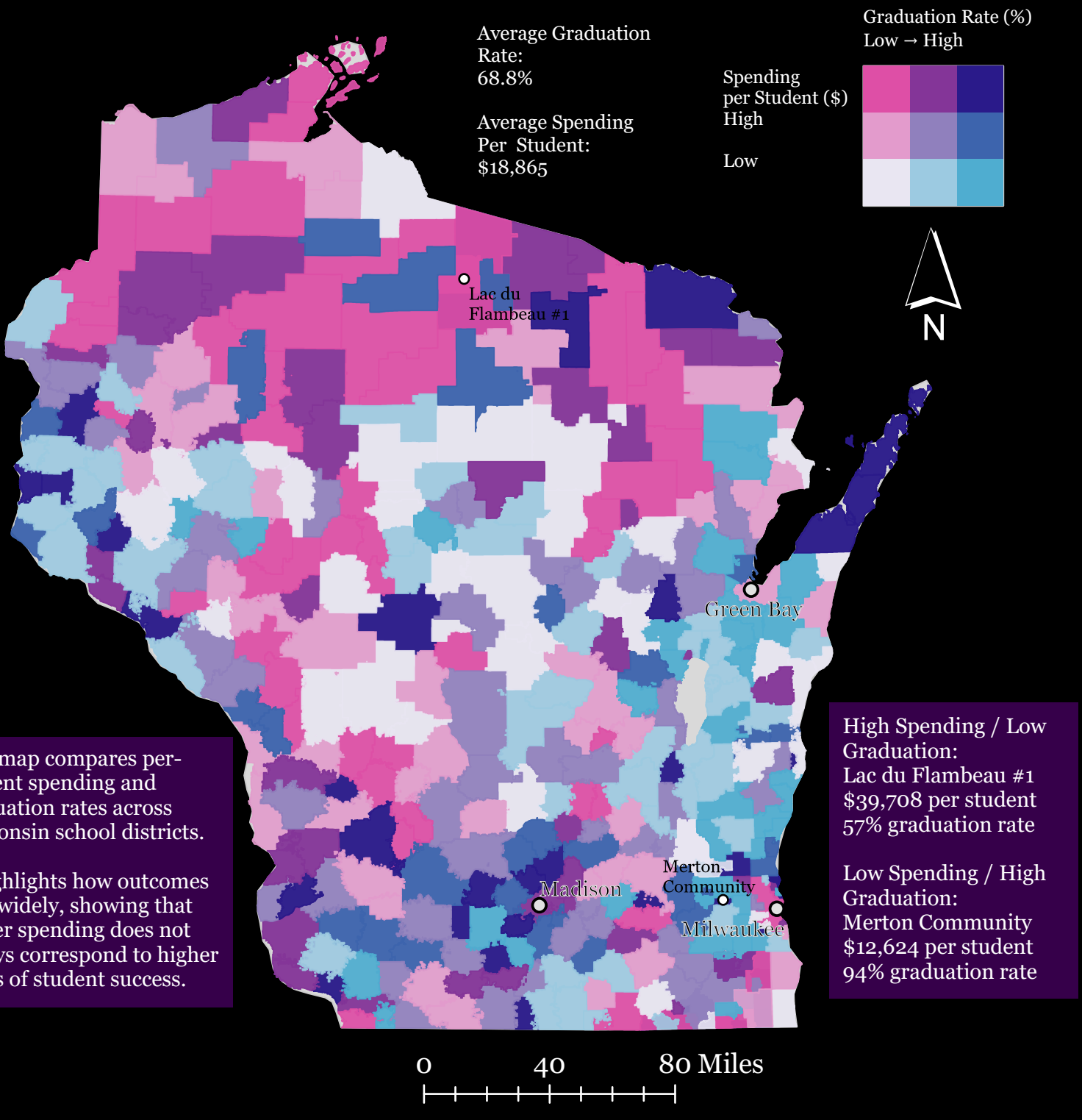
Public School Spending vs Graduation Rates in Wisconsin (2023-24)



This map compares per-student spending and graduation rates across Wisconsin school districts.

It highlights how outcomes vary widely, showing that higher spending does not always correspond to higher levels of student success.

High Spending / Low Graduation:
Lac du Flambeau #1
$39,708 per student
57% graduation rate

Low Spending / High Graduation:
Merton Community
$12,624 per student
94% graduation rate

Cartographer: William Day
Data Source: Wisconsin Department of Public Instruction (2023-2024)
Basemap: Lab 1 Geography 370
Date: April 25th, 2026
USA Contiguous Albers Equal Area Conic
Central Meridian: -90 deg
Standard Parallels: 43 deg N, 47 deg N

Key Findings:
- Higher spending does not guarantee higher graduation rates
- Significant variation exists across districts
- Outliers highlight inefficiencies in funding outcomes